

PEOPLE (on the move)

MEMS and Sensors Group, will step down from his position on 31st August to become CEO of another company.

Hao Hong moves from Samsung to Intel as VP

Hao Hong, a former head of Samsung Electronics America's foundry division, has joined Intel. Intel recently announced

re-entry in the foundry business. Hong has joined Intel as a vice president of global business development. He had handled Samsung's foundry business for more than six years.



MeitY to formulate action plan for e-waste around circular economy

NITI Aayog has entrusted the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology (MeitY) to formulate an action plan for implementation of circular economy (CE) principles in the e-waste sector to expedite the focus on CE and ensure the transition of India from a linear to a circular economy. India generated 3.2 million tonnes of e-waste in 2019, ranking third in the world. The FICCI Circular Economy Report, 2017 outlined that the business opportunity for extracting gold from e-waste is to the tune of \$0.7 to \$1 billion. And there are many more precious metals that can be extracted.

Several companies interested in Li-ion batteries manufacture

The list of companies showing interest in the manufacture of lithium-ion battery cells in India is growing thanks to the ever-growing demand for EV batteries and some others. The long list of companies now includes the likes of Reliance Industries, Adani Group, Tata Chemicals, Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Heavy Electricals, Exide Industries, Amara Raja Batteries, Greenko Group, Renew Power, and a joint venture led by Suzuki Motor Corp. All of them have shown interest in the government of India's recent PLI scheme for lithium-ion cell manufacture.

India trying to lead in 6G, having lagged in 5G

Telecom Standards Development Society of India (TSDSI) has submitted its vision document on 6G broadband technology to the ITU-Radiocommunications Sector (ITU-R), which is an arm of the global International Telecommunications Union (ITU). TSDSI started deliberating on futuristic

telecom technologies in January 2020 when it held a workshop on 'Telecom Technologies for the Next Decade.' The Networks Study Group of TSDSI is currently doing a study on use cases and requirements of 6G. After having got late in implementation of the 5G technology, it would do good to India if the country could be a leader in 6G.

Government planning to solarise agricultural feeders

The government of India is planning to announce soon a scheme for solarising agricultural feeders, according to the Power and Renewable Energy Minister R.K. Singh. The government intends to put aside ₹200 billion for this scheme. As 1GW solar plant requires around 3.125 million photovoltaic panels, a 100GW plant would require around 312.5 million panels. India, at the moment, has the capability of manufacturing solar panels for only 3GW capacity.

India's smart TVs segment witnesses 55% growth in Q1

Smart TVs recorded a 55 percent annual growth in the Q1 of 2021 in India. Most of the TV OEMs focused on increasing their product portfolios with smart TVs, which brought down the entry-level price point to \$160. India's TV shipments grew 10 percent on year-to-year basis to reach 3 million units in Q1 of 2021, driven by increased OTT content consumption and consequently due to a growth in average time spent. In contrast, the non-smart TV category declined in the Indian market and recorded a 46 percent yearly fall in shipments during the same period.

Incentive scheme likely for investment to set up fabless display plants

Amid rising interest from various global and Indian companies to set up a fabless display manufacturing plant in the country, the government is finally

looking to devise an incentive scheme within the next six months to draw 3-4 large investments in the sector. "Based on what we get from the expressions of interest that we have received and the extensive discussions that we have had with all the major players in this space over the past three months...we will attempt to come out with a scheme or incentive structure based on which we will then invite proposals to set up such manufacturing within India...within the next six months," said Ajay Prakash Sawhney, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics.

India needs 400,000 charging stations for 2 million EVs by 2026

A new report suggests that India would need around 400,000 charging stations to meet the requirement for two million electric vehicles (EVs), a number that is expected to ply on Indian roads by 2026. There are currently 1,800 charging stations in India for approximately 16,200 electric cars, including the fleet segment. More than half of the stakeholders have also recommended the involvement of discoms in electric vehicle supply equipment deployment and classification of EV charging infrastructure as corporate social responsibility.

GeM portal sees sales of ACs worth ₹1.7 billion

Last year, the Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal saw sales of over 44,000 air-conditioners worth ₹1.7 billion, and it continues to grow. On the occasion of World Environment Day, a new product category of Green Room Air-Conditioners was launched on GeM. Now the portal will enable and encourage all central and state government agencies to buy efficient and environment-friendly 'green' ACs, thereby paving a way for sustainable public procurement in India. However, the purchase of green ACs shall be voluntary.